

La Casa at Indiana University Bloomington: Creating a Community-Driven Digital Archive in an Institutional Context

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Latin American & Caribbean Digital
Humanities Symposium

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Collaborators

This presentation is co-authored by two additional collaborators not here today:

- **Lillian Casillas**, Director of La Casa / Latino Cultural Center:
mlcasill@iu.edu
- **Kalani Craig**, Associate Professor in History, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign: kcraig@illinois.edu

Along with additional collaborators: Emily Clark, Madison Cissell, Michael Garza, Drew Heidersheidt, Marisa Hicks-Alcaraz, Nate Howard, David Kloster, Matt Landini, Sean Purcell, Carrie Schwier, Jazma Sutton, Ruth Vaca and several volunteers affiliated with La Casa and IDAH.

Motivations for Community Archiving

- Community Ownership and Control
- Accessible, Scaffolded Support and Training
- Equity in the Historical Record
- Sustainable, Community-Led Capacity Building
- Transparency Around Digital Ethics and Infrastructure
- Investment in Intergenerational and Local Knowledge

<https://digitalarcplatform.github.io/values/>

La Casa/Latino Cultural Center



- Established in 1973 as a connection between the university and the Latine community in Bloomington.
- “La Casa provides programming, support, and opportunities to foster a sense of belonging and pride for Latine students, while assisting in their academic, leadership, professional, and social development.”
- 2023 marked the 50th anniversary of the center’s opening.
- Collaboration with the center came from the scarcity of findable archival records and the desire to document the history of Latine students at IU, especially during a period of institutional erasure.

50th Anniversary

[Home](#) / [Programming](#)
LA CASA'S 50TH

La Casa's 50th Anniversary

The Golden Years!

In the fall of 2023, La Casa will celebrate its 50th anniversary. This milestone is due to the many students, faculty, staff, and alumni who have contributed to building a strong community. In commemoration of this anniversary, plans are underway to welcome back all those who have walked through its doors and supported its advocacy, programs, and services — those who have been a part of La Casa's life and success!

In preparation for the 50th anniversary, we ask you to submit **photos of IU and/or La Casa memories** that we can share with the comunidad. Photos will be compiled into a slideshow shared at different moments during the reunion. You do not have to attend the event to submit photos. Thank you in advance for sharing your memories with us!

Reunion Itinerary

See a schedule of events.

Share Your Photos and Videos

Submit your photos and videos of IU and/or La Casa memories.

Proclaiming Our Stories: Creating a Community Digital Archive



LA CASA
LATINO CULTURAL CENTER
1973-2023

9 a.m. - Noon

Check-In

La
Casa/Latino
Cultural
Center

10 - 11 a.m.

Latine College Experience: Building Their Success

While greater numbers of Latine students are entering institutions of higher education, they still face many challenges. Faculty will share their research, insights and strategies to better support Latine students. Co-sponsored by Latino Faculty and Staff Council, Arthur R. Metz Grant (IU Student Foundation), La Casa, and Latinos Unidos (LUIU).

IMU /
Solarium

10 a.m. -
2 p.m.

Proclaiming Our Stories: Creating a Community Digital Archive

Digital storytelling is a powerful form of sharing personal experiences that enables individuals and communities to proclaim and reclaim their cultural identities and narratives through personal and meaningful items like photos or home movies. We are especially interested in archiving an object and story from your time at Indiana University that will form part of La Casa's Digital Community Archive. We welcome your stories, illustrated by an artifact, on what it means to be Latine or Latin-American during your time at Indiana University. Registration is required to participate.

La
Casa/Latino
Cultural
Center

[Submit Here](#)

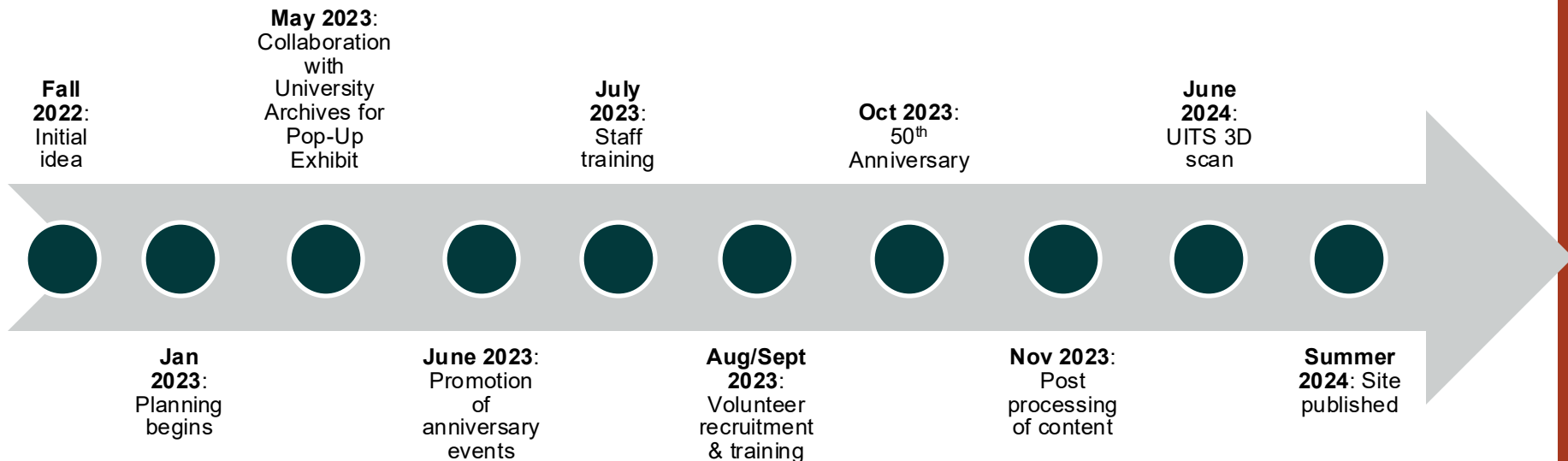
From One Generation to Another: Connecting the Dots

This alumni and current Latine student panel will reflect on what has stayed the same and what has changed across the years in the Latine student experience at IU.

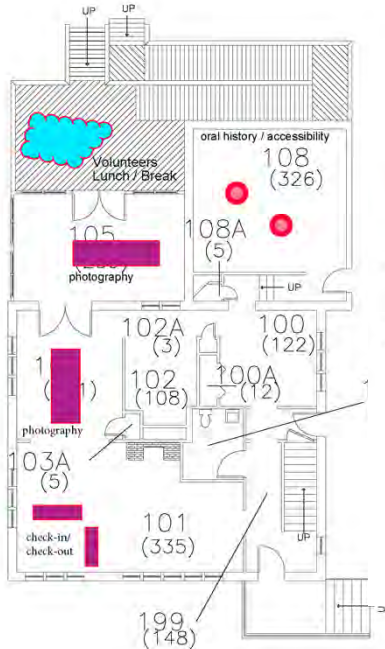
IMU /
Solarium

11:15 a.m. - 12:15 p.m.

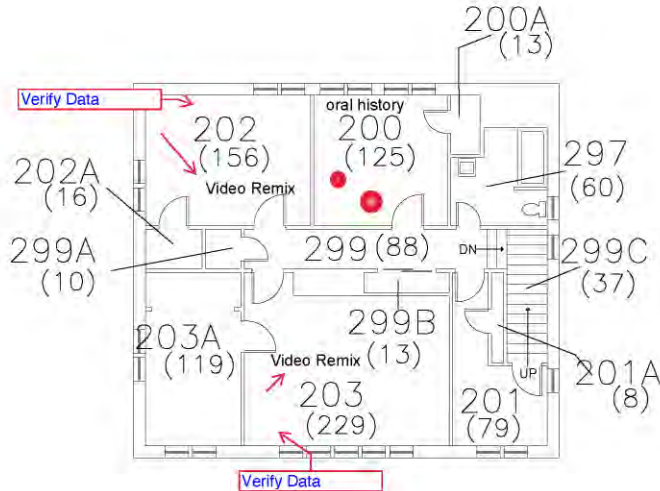
La Casa Community Archive: The Process



La Casa Community Archive: Day of

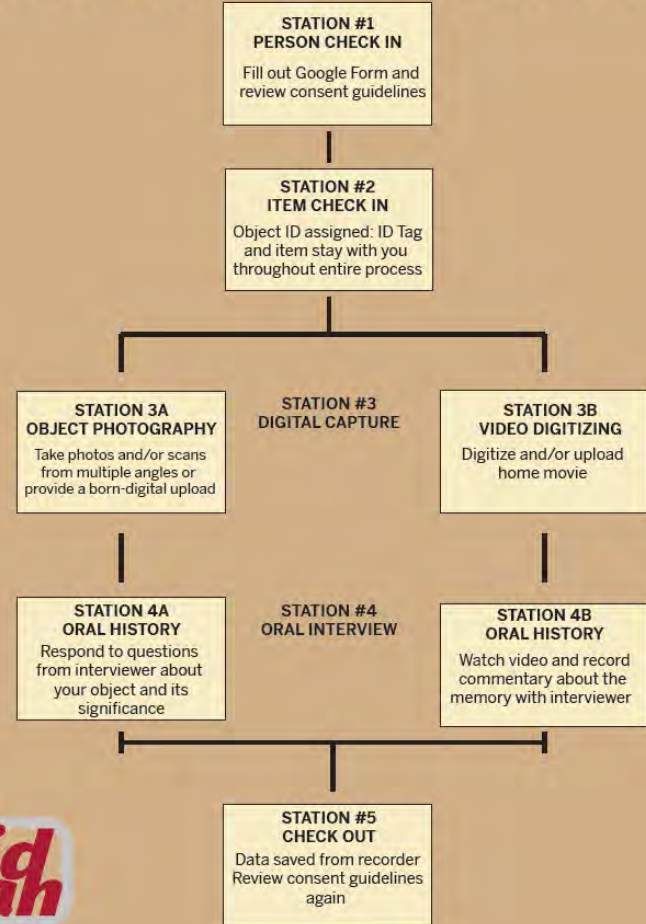


First Floor



Second Floor

COMMUNITY ARCHIVE COLLECTION PROCESS



La Casa Community Archive: Day of Event



Photography Station

Check-In Station



View of Check-In
Station from
Photography
Station

La Casa Community Archive: Post Event Processing

Return raw
files to
contributors

Oral history
transcripts

Photo
editing

Metadata
clean-up

Prep/upload
content to
platform

Publish site

La Casa Community Archive: Additional Partnerships

- University Information Technology Services: Visualization and Digitization Systems
- 3D scan of the entire house using Matterport 360 camera
- Oral histories of each room of the house



Virtual Tour

Take a virtual tour of La Casa, a vibrant gem within IU's cultural community, and discover its unique spaces designed to foster connection and belonging.

[Take the tour](#)

View the virtual tour



La Casa's 50th Anniversary Archive

HOME/LA CASA COMMUNITY/COMUNIDAD ANNIVERSARY/ANIVERSARIO 3D WALKTHROUGH

OUR COLLECTION

In the fall of 2023, La Casa celebrated its 50th anniversary. This milestone is due to the many students, faculty, staff, and alumni who have contributed to building a strong community. In commemoration of this anniversary, we welcomed back all those who have walked through its doors and supported its advocacy, programs, and services — those who have been a part of La Casa's life and success! La Casa alumni brought back memories that we share with the the whole comunidad here.

1970	1980	1990	2000	2010	2020	Academic life	Activism	Business
Community	Family	Health Science	La Casa history	La Casa house	La Casa virtual tour			
Languages	Latine organizations	Media Studies	STEM	Social Science	Special events			

- ☐ 3D Walkthrough
- ☐ Documents
- ☐ Photos
- ☐ Small objects
- ☐ Stories and memories



El Reloj Adelantado

Juan Manuel Vazquez
Castillo

It is a watch from my grandfather and it reminds me of many memories/conversations we had (read more...)



Home away from Home

Jonathan Hernandez

La Casa is our own little hub, our own little community. (read more...)



A time of activism

Olga Cruz Arreguin

Stories and photos are about the time I spent at IU as a student and activist (read more...)

<https://lacasaiu.github.io/>

- Event resulted in 24 contributions
- Collection of images from the banquet dinner
- 3D walkthrough of the house with oral histories of each of the rooms of the house by the current director, Lillian Casillas.



DigitalArc Toolkit

[HOME](#)[ABOUT DIGITALARC](#)[USING DIGITALARC](#)[EXAMPLE SITE](#)

An exhibit platform for collective storytelling & community archives

ABOUT DIGITALARC

Digital Archiving & Storytelling for Historically Excluded Communities

DigitalArc provides relatively easy and inexpensive approaches to organizing, collecting and publishing your histories. More than platforms for publishing your stories and processes for capturing your stories, DigitalArc **focuses on the people who contribute their stories**. [Visit the About DigitalArc page to learn more.](#)

Whether your community leads the entire digital archiving initiative, from start to finish, or you partner with local organizations, we provide guidance from planning to publishing your digital archive. Our goal is to provide step-by-step instructions that can be easily tailored for your community needs so you can lead and manage this whole process. The stories you are sharing are yours. You should have options for managing how your stories are shared.

DigitalArc Highlights

[Visit DigitalArc Highlights](#) to learn more..



Workshop attendees and organizers.



About the DigitalArc team

Our team got its start at the [Institute for Digital Arts and Humanities](#) at Indiana University Bloomington and

OUR GOAL: Provide a framework from start-to-finish in which a community could pursue storytelling & story-sharing without institutional support

OUR REALITY: Community work is often supported and augmented by local, institutional resources & partnerships

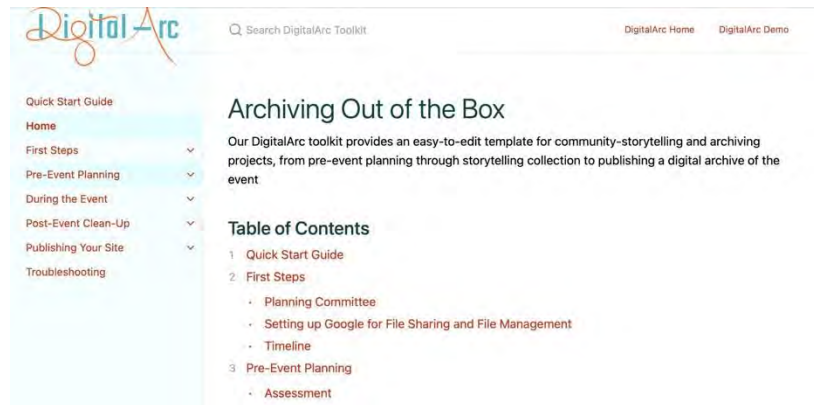
Funded by the American Council of Learned Societies, Digital Justice program

<https://digitalarcplatform.github.io/>

DigitalArc Process & Platform

DigitalArc Toolkit Documentation

- First Steps: Project Management and File Organization
- Pre-Event Planning
- During the Event
- Post-Event Prep of the Content
- Publishing the Content



DigitalArc Platform Template

- GitHub Pages / Jekyll lightweight framework for publishing; following minimal computing best practices
- Static-content: online or offline hosting, easier maintenance, more sustainable platform



DigitalArc Next Steps with Community Partners

Gary, Indiana (Collaborative)



[This is Gary](#)
[Calumet Collaborative](#)
[Samuel Love](#) (Independent
Historian)
[Morning Bishop Theatre](#)
[Playhouse](#)

Indiana University Northwest

Bethel A.M.E. Oxford, Ohio



[Bethel A.M.E. Oxford, Ohio](#), The
Bethel African Methodist
Episcopal Church is the oldest of
Oxford's four Historically Black
Churches with a congregation
that's been around for over 175
years.
Miami University in Oxford

Roberts Settlement Central Indiana



[Roberts Settlement](#), an African-
American pioneer farm
settlement founded in 1835 by
free blacks who migrated mostly
from North Carolina and Virginia.

Indiana Historical Society

Questions?

- [@digitalarc.bsky.social](https://twitter.com/digitalarc)
- digitalarcplatform@gmail.com
- <https://digitalarcplatform.github.io/>
- Michelle Dalmau, PI for DigitalArc / Director of Digital Collections & Digitization Services, Indiana University Libraries, mdalmau@iu.edu
- Vanessa Elias, Co-PI for DigitalArc / Information Specialist – Digital Projects, University of Texas at San Antonio Libraries & Museums, vanessa.elias@utsa.edu

Previous Projects

<https://iubhistoryharvest.github.io/>

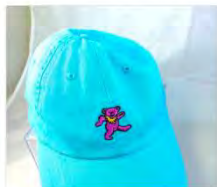
 History Harvest

H301 Histories IU History Harvest Artifacts Search...

Identity Through Objects: Fall 2019 IU Bloomington History Harvest

History Harvest Artifacts

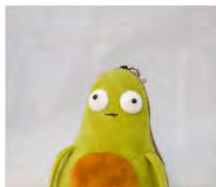
Each of the artifacts below was contributed by a member of the IU community during our History Harvest event in October of 2019.



Grateful Dead Hat

Drew Heiderscheidt

A turquoise strap-back hat with a 1-inch purple embroidered Grateful Dead dancing bear on the front.



Guacardo Plush Toy

Vanessa Elias

Stuffed Avacado from "wearemitu"



Berlin Subway Ticket

Navdeep Sharma

A subway ticket from the Berlin subway.

<https://longtownhistory.github.io/>

HOME BOUND CATALOGUE RECEPTION

HOME BOUND CATALOGUE

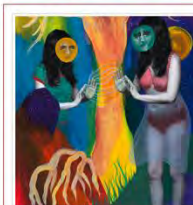
All	Maggie Rushton	Liliana Guzmán	Ben Shaffer	Olivia Kolich	Elena W.	Flora Arthur	Elizabeth Blackwell	Jade Stern	Gloria M. Colon-Brida
Victoria Vu	Kenzey-Layne	Lily Bird-MacNeil-Kitchner	Reggie Jones	Claudia Gonzales Diaz					



What lives on?

Maggie Rushton

Observations. Knowledge of what our ancestors' lives were like is passed down through cultural objects and where my ancestors are from, that is passed down through textile patterns. In Scotland... (read more...)



Forever Tree

Liliana Guzmán

Growing up, my childhood best friend and I would often invent special rituals. There was a specific tree in my backyard where we would go (usually in the summer) to... (read more...)



Night Visit

Liliana Guzmán

Collected memories, experiences and dreams continuously make up the person that I am in this present moment, many of which have transpired in and around the places I've lived. In... (read more...)

<https://homeboundatiu.github.io/>

Remembering Freedom: Longtown and Greenville History Harvest

Descendant Histories History Harvest Tour Longtown Homecoming Event

Remembering Freedom Longtown and Greenville History Harvest

Longtown Descendants

"By memory, those fond associations and ties of love which unite us together on earth, will be preserved in eternity...Memory should be cultivated. Like all other faculties of the mind and body, its vigor and activity depend on its exercise. The more the memory is exercised the stronger it becomes." - J. B. Harrison, Greenville Settlement, 1864

Descendants' Historical Collections



Gladys Collins

View items from the collection of Gladys Collins



Longtown Descendant Facebook Group

View items from the collection of Longtown Descendant Facebook Group



Ricky Cottman

View items from the collection of Ricky Cottman

The voices of Greenville and Longtown

- Ricky Cottman
- Julia Boatman and Loretta Taylor (née Hickman)
- Patricia Hope
- Tera Crawford Huffman
- Jim
- Celeste Jordan
- Cleo Fay Goens Mason
- Woodrow W. Rickman II
- Roane Smothers
- Ricky Spraglia and Celeste Jordan Pike